

Tallulah Hartwell

Character Dossier

Sunny and relentlessly optimistic herbalist of the Academy of Vell

Overview

Tallulah Hartwell is a herbalist living in the Academy of Vell. Tallulah is 30 years old, originally from Marrow's End, and is known around the Hall of Echoes as sunny and relentlessly optimistic. In conversation Tallulah tells long stories that circle back to the point eventually.

Background

Tallulah arrived in the Academy of Vell 22 years ago after leaving Marrow's End under circumstances Tallulah describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Faculty of Applied Wonders; the second was the one that stuck. Today Tallulah works as a herbalist near the north observatory and is paid, when paid at all, in guilders.

Tallulah learned the trade from Matthias Ellery, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Tallulah's life is with Greta Falkenrath, over a matter neither will explain. The person Tallulah trusts most is Wren Achterberg.

Current goal: to build a boat with no nails in it. Greatest fear: a knock at the door after dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: sunny and relentlessly optimistic.

Speech pattern: Tallulah tells long stories that circle back to the point eventually.

Tells: when lying, Tallulah mentions Ollie the beetle for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Tallulah Hartwell
Role	herbalist
Home	the Academy of Vell
Hometown	Marrow's End
Age	30
Favourite dish	grandmother's spiced pumpkin dumplings
Pet	Ollie, a beetle
Lucky number	806

<i>Workshop password</i>	plume-indigo
<i>Mentor</i>	Matthias Ellery
<i>Rival</i>	Greta Falkenrath
<i>Closest friend</i>	Wren Achterberg

Secret

Tallulah secretly funds an orphanage in Marrow's End and would be mortified if anyone found out.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Tallulah: I am the herbalist. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Tallulah: Grandmother's spiced pumpkin dumplings. Do not tell Greta I said so.

Visitor: Is Ollie yours?

Tallulah: Ollie belongs to nobody. Ollie tolerates me. Lucky number is 806, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 28

A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Tallulah and a neighbour outside the candle library; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Tallulah and a neighbour outside the candle library; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Tallulah for the password to the workshop. Tallulah laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Tallulah was hired to carry a ledger from the candle library to the greenhouse cloisters without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Tallulah was hired to carry a cracked compass from the candle library to the greenhouse cloisters without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 2, summer of year 28

The weather turned. Tallulah moved the sextant indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. The weather turned. Tallulah moved the coil of rope indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about who really won the regatta. The weather turned. Tallulah moved the pair of spectacles indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about whether the bridge will hold. Tallulah spent the day counting stock at the north observatory: 88 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short.

Entry 3, winter of year 28

Tallulah repaired the wax seal at the Hall of Echoes for Octavia, who paid in 80 guilders and a long story about the singing at the docks. Rowan came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Tallulah said nothing useful and made tea instead. Tallulah repaired the grain scale at the Hall of Echoes for Matthias, who paid in 44 guilders and a long story about the quarantine. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Tallulah and a neighbour outside the Hall of Echoes; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Tallulah and a neighbour outside the Hall of Echoes; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 4, winter of year 28

Rumours about the comet reached the bell tower. Tallulah pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Tallulah spent the day counting stock at the bell tower: 63 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Tallulah found a sack of salt half-buried near the bell tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Tallulah read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 5, autumn of year 28

Tallulah was hired to carry a sack of salt from the Hall of Echoes to the bell tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Tallulah won 22 guilders on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Tallulah and a neighbour outside the Hall of Echoes; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked

Tallulah for the password to the workshop. Tallulah laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 6, winter of year 28

Tallulah was hired to carry a wax seal from the Hall of Echoes to the bell tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Tallulah won 19 guilders on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. Tallulah closed early, walked to the bell tower, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Tallulah and a neighbour outside the Hall of Echoes; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Tallulah for the password to the workshop. Tallulah laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 7, autumn of year 28

Rumours about the comet reached the greenhouse cloisters. Tallulah pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the greenhouse cloisters, Tallulah taught a newcomer how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the greenhouse cloisters. Tallulah pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Tallulah has a suspect and is probably right. Tallulah won 44 guilders on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 8, summer of year 28

At the bell tower, Tallulah taught a newcomer how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Tallulah and a neighbour outside the bell tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Wilhelmina came by asking about the old tunnels. Tallulah said nothing useful and made tea instead. Nkechi came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Tallulah said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 9, autumn of year 29

the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the comet. Tallulah read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Tallulah closed early, walked to the bell tower, and watched the lights come on. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Tallulah read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 10, winter of year 29

A stranger asked Tallulah for the password to the workshop. Tallulah laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Tallulah and a neighbour outside the candle library; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Tallulah was hired to carry a sextant from the candle library to the greenhouse cloisters without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 11, autumn of year 29

Tallulah repaired the bundle of letters at the Hall of Echoes for Kwame, who paid in 77 guilders and a long story about the old tunnels. Tallulah closed early, walked to the candle library, and watched the lights come on. The weather turned. Tallulah moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks. Tallulah repaired the grain scale at the Hall of Echoes for

Zora, who paid in 66 guilders and a long story about the old tunnels.